



How can India build a credible examination system that ensures fairness, autonomy, and meaningful assessment?

Radhakrishnan Committee • National Testing Agency • Computer-Adaptive Testing • Psychometrics • Academic Autonomy

GS II

Governance
Education and
Human Resource
Development

📖 KNOWLEDGE POINTS

- **Institutional Reform:** The 2024 Radhakrishnan Committee proposed restructuring the National Testing Agency into a statutory, professionally managed institution. Strong governance, specialised functional divisions, and legal backing improve examination credibility, accountability, and operational independence.
- **Assessment Philosophy:** Entrance examinations should evaluate analytical ability, conceptual understanding, and application rather than rote memorisation. Sound Psychometrics enables scientifically designed assessments that improve reliability, fairness, and measurement of genuine academic competence.
- **Technology Integration:** Computer-Adaptive Testing adjusts question difficulty according to candidate performance, improving precision while reducing opportunities for malpractice. Secure digital infrastructure, biometric verification, cybersecurity, and standardised testing centres strengthen examination integrity.
- **Academic Ownership:** High-quality examinations require continuous involvement of universities, professional institutions, and subject experts. Academic Autonomy ensures question quality, curriculum relevance, institutional responsibility, and greater public confidence in national assessment systems.
- **Implementation Challenges:** Institutional reforms require adequate staffing, specialised expertise, statutory support, sustainable funding, and administrative capacity. Long-term success depends on coordinated governance rather than isolated technological solutions or temporary crisis management.

📋 QUICK FACTS

- **Radhakrishnan Committee (2024):** Recommended transforming the National Testing Agency into a statutory institution with specialised functional verticals for examination governance.
- **National Testing Agency:** Established in 2018 as an autonomous organisation under the Ministry of Education to conduct major national entrance examinations.
- **Computer-Adaptive Testing:** Widely used in international examinations such as the GRE, where question difficulty changes according to candidate responses.
- **Psychometrics:** The scientific discipline concerned with designing, validating, and evaluating tests to ensure reliability, validity, and fairness of assessments.

🎯 KEY TAKEAWAY

Credible public examinations require strong institutions, scientific assessment methods, academic participation, and transparent governance rather than relying solely on technological safeguards.



How can constitutional democracies protect peaceful protest while ensuring proportionate policing and public order?

Article 19 • Proportionality • Graduated Response • Independent Inquiry • Seventh Schedule

GS II

Polity

Fundamental Rights

📖 KNOWLEDGE POINTS

- **Constitutional Protection:** Peaceful protest is a democratic means of expressing dissent and influencing public policy. Article 19 protects freedom of speech and peaceful assembly while permitting only reasonable restrictions to safeguard legitimate public interests.
- **Proportionate Policing:** Law enforcement must use only the minimum force necessary to address actual threats. The principle of Proportionality requires police action to remain lawful, necessary, reasonable, and appropriate to the circumstances.
- **Graduated Response:** Modern crowd management follows a Graduated Response by prioritising communication, warnings, protective equipment, negotiation, and controlled escalation before resorting to stronger crowd-control measures to minimise injuries and preserve public confidence.
- **Independent Oversight:** Allegations of excessive force require impartial investigation to maintain institutional credibility. Independent Inquiry, evidence preservation, medical documentation, and transparent accountability mechanisms strengthen both public trust and professional policing standards.
- **Uniform Standards:** Policing is a State subject under the Seventh Schedule, leading to variations in training and operational practices. National protocols can promote consistent documentation, accountability, and human-rights-compliant crowd-control procedures across States.

📋 QUICK FACTS

- **Article 19(1)(a) and Article 19(1)(b):** Guarantee freedom of speech and the right to assemble peacefully without arms, reasonable restrictions under Articles 19(2) and 19(3).
- **Seventh Schedule:** Places "Police" and "Public Order" in the State List, making States primarily responsible for policing and law-and-order administration.
- **UN Basic Principles on the Use of Force and Firearms:** Require law-enforcement officials to use force only when necessary, lawful, and proportionate to a legitimate objective.
- **Prakash Singh v. Union of India (2006):** The Supreme Court directed structural police reforms, including State Security Commissions and Police Complaints Authorities to improve accountability.

🎯 KEY TAKEAWAY

Constitutional democracy protects peaceful dissent most effectively when policing remains lawful, proportionate, transparent, and accountable while preserving both public order and civil liberties.



How can India balance farmer income security with efficient and sustainable agricultural market reforms?

Minimum Support Price • Price Deficiency Payment • Minimum Income Support • Pulse Self-Sufficiency • Crop Diversification

GS III

Agriculture

Agricultural Marketing

📖 KNOWLEDGE POINTS

- **Price Support:** Minimum Support Price (MSP) protects farmers from sharp price declines by assuring a minimum procurement price. However, procurement is often selective, fiscally expensive, and unable to cover the entire marketed surplus across crops and regions.
- **Price Deficiency Payment:** Under a Price Deficiency Payment system, governments compensate farmers for the gap between the MSP and the market price without physically procuring produce. This reduces storage costs while providing income protection.
- **Minimum Income Support:** Minimum Income Support (MIP) provides direct per-acre financial assistance independent of procurement. Stable income support allows farmers to make production decisions based on market demand rather than government procurement incentives.
- **Crop Diversification:** Expanding cultivation of pulses and oilseeds strengthens Pulse Self-Sufficiency, reduces import dependence, conserves water compared to surplus cereals, and promotes more balanced and climate-resilient agricultural systems.
- **Market-Oriented Reforms:** Long-term agricultural sustainability requires Crop Diversification, rural infrastructure, agricultural research, crop insurance, and efficient markets. Productive public investment can improve farm incomes more effectively than excessive reliance on price support alone.

📋 QUICK FACTS

- **Minimum Support Price:** The Commission for Agricultural Costs and Prices (CACP) recommends MSPs for 23 notified crops, while the Union Government announces the final MSPs.
- **PM-AASHA Scheme (2018):** Introduced mechanisms including Price Deficiency Payment to support farmers when market prices fall below MSP for selected crops.
- **PM-KISAN:** Provides income support of ₹6,000 annually to eligible farmer families through Direct Benefit Transfer, independent of crop procurement.
- **India remains substantially dependent on imports of edible oils, making higher domestic production of oilseeds an important agricultural policy objective.**

🎯 KEY TAKEAWAY

Sustainable agricultural prosperity depends on securing farmer incomes through efficient markets, diversified cropping, and targeted income support rather than relying primarily on large-scale procurement.



How can durable peace in Gaza balance security concerns, humanitarian needs, and political reconciliation?

Two-State Solution • Demilitarisation • Humanitarian Law • Collective Punishment • Post-Conflict Reconstruction

GS II

International Relations

West Asia

📖 KNOWLEDGE POINTS

- **Conflict Resolution:** Long-term peace requires addressing both immediate security concerns and the underlying political dispute. The internationally supported Two-State Solution remains the most widely accepted framework for achieving lasting peace between Israel and Palestine.
- **Demilitarisation:** Demilitarisation seeks to reduce or eliminate armed capabilities to prevent renewed conflict. Successful implementation depends on credible security guarantees, mutual trust, phased commitments, and effective international monitoring by neutral institutions.
- **Humanitarian Protection:** International Humanitarian Law requires parties to armed conflict to protect civilians and ensure access to food, medicine, and essential services. Humanitarian assistance must remain independent of political or military negotiations during armed conflicts.
- **Collective Punishment:** Collective Punishment occurs when civilian populations are penalised for actions they did not individually commit. International humanitarian law prohibits measures that intentionally inflict suffering on civilians to achieve military or political objectives.
- **Peacebuilding:** Post-Conflict Reconstruction extends beyond rebuilding infrastructure to restoring governance, public services, livelihoods, and institutional legitimacy. Sustainable peace depends on inclusive political arrangements, economic recovery, and long-term reconciliation among affected communities.

📋 QUICK FACTS

- **Fourth Geneva Convention (1949):** Provides legal protection to civilians during armed conflict and prohibits collective punishment in occupied territories.
- **United Nations Relief and Works Agency (UNRWA):** Supports Palestinian refugees by providing education, healthcare, and humanitarian assistance across the region.
- **Two-State Solution:** Envisions Israel and an independent Palestinian state coexisting peacefully based on negotiated political arrangements.
- **Oslo Accords (1993–95):** Established mutual recognition between Israel and the Palestine Liberation Organization (PLO) and created the Palestinian Authority as an interim self-governing body.

🎯 KEY TAKEAWAY

Lasting peace in conflict zones requires balancing legitimate security concerns with humanitarian obligations, inclusive political dialogue, and sustainable post-conflict reconstruction.